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FROM WASHINGTON TO FOREIGN OFFICE

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Sir O. Franks

No. 107 D. 11.00 p.m. 10th January, 1952

10th January, 1952 R. 10.00 a.m. 11th January, 1952

PRIORITY

SECRET

Addressed to Foreign Office telegram No. 107 of 10th January

Repeated for information to Tokyo

Following from Secretary of State.

Japan's relations with China.

I discussed this for about an hour with Acheson and Dulles this morning. Dulles deployed a wide variety of arguments in support of the American case. He said little about United States domestic complications but it was clear from the discussion that this was the main preoccupation of the Americans.

2. Both Acheson and Dulles agreed that it would be better if nothing need have been done or said until the coming into effect of the multilateral treaty. Dulles however described this as a "counsel of perfection" Acheson explained candidly that the "China lobby" Senators might well be able to muster the necessary one-third vote to delay ratification (or even to attach conditions) unless something was done to meet their views.

3. After a long discussion I said I clearly understood these American difficulties. But I had not altered my view. If I were questioned I should have to say that my view was unchanged and that I had made it known to the Americans. I could not agree that the course of action which the Americans felt compelled to pursue was wise in the circumstances. However I was glad to know that in any case the Japanese would take no formal action to conclude arrangements with China before the full ratification of the Japanese Peace Treaty. It made some difference that any final action would be taken when the Japanese had recovered their full liberty of action.

A. Acheson .....

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Washington telegram No. 107 to Foreign Office

4. Acheson then said that Yoshida would ask Dening what was the result of our conversation. He hoped that Dening would be instructed to say that while still maintaining our view we should not disagree if the Japanese wished to pursue discussions with Formosa on the lines recently discussed by Dulles in Tokyo. I have since told the Americans that I would suggest to Dening that he should speak on the following lines:

"Mr. Acheson explained the United States views to Mr. Eden and went over the difficulties he foresaw particularly the domestic difficulties of securing ratification of the Peace Treaty by the United States Senate. Mr. Eden fully appreciated these difficulties but made it clear that he could not change his view. He still thought that the wisest course was for the Japanese Government to make no commitments before the coming into force of the multilateral treaty of peace. Mr. Yoshida would be aware that it has never been the desire of His Majesty's Government to exert pressure on the Japanese Government to follow any particular course. Our desire has been that the Japanese should follow the course which they themselves believe to be in their own interests. For this reason we should have preferred the Japanese to enter into no commitments until Japan had regained her full sovereignty. The exchange of views between Mr. Acheson and Mr. Eden was full and cordial and there was complete mutual understanding. Though in this respect the result was an agreement to disagree this in no way affected the existing broad area of agreement between the two Governments on all other matters relating to Japan. His Majesty's Government will continue in the future as in the past to exert no pressure on the Japanese Government to pursue any particular policy in regard to their relations with China".

5. The Americans made it clear throughout that any arrangements with Formosa would be limited to Formosa and that they could not come into effect until the coming into force of the multilateral treaty. At one point Dulles spoke on a personal basis of using the existence of civil war in China and said that if Japan entered into de facto relations with one

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of the belligerent parties she might not be thereby precluded from entering into relations with the other belligerent. He added that this fell short of the official United States position and implied that he had in effect been restraining the Japanese from recognising Chiang as the Government of all China. I do not think the implication valid.

Please pass to Tokyo as my telegram 5.
[Repeated to Tokyo]

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